

CRAM SHEET

Bladder & Kidney Channels – Week 5

67 + 27 = 94 points · Foot-Taiyang & Foot-Shaoyin

Quiz Ready · Posterior Circuit Complete

BLADDER

67 pts · Water/Yang
3–5 PM · 5 branches

KIDNEY

27 pts · Water/Yin
5–7 PM · 3 branches

CIRCUIT

Posterior/Inner done:
HT+SI+BL+KI

+ trap notes, confusable pairs, Back-Shu series, and full special-points map inside

This is a NIGHT-BEFORE density reference — pairs with the full Study Guide.
One page per channel, front to back, plus a full quick-scan point grid.

The Bladder Meridian of Foot-Taiyang

Yang | Water | 3 PM – 5 PM | 67 pts

PATHWAY — 5 branches

1st: BL1 Jingming · Last: BL67 Zhiyin

1. Inner canthus -> vertex
2. vertex -> temple
3. vertex -> bladder
4. lumbar region -> popliteal fossa
5. posterior neck -> little toe

SPECIAL POINTS

- Jing-Well: BL67 Zhiyin
- Ying-Spring: BL66 Zutonggu
- Shu-Stream: BL65 Shugu
- Jing-River: BL60 Kunlun
- He-Sea: BL40 Weizhong
- Yuan-Source: BL64 Jinggu
- Luo-Connecting: BL58 Feiyang
- Xi-Cleft: BL63 Jinmen
- Front-Mu (of Bladder): CV3 Zhongji
- Back-Shu (of Bladder): BL28 Pangguangshu
- Command Point (back): BL40 Weizhong

BACK-SHU SERIES (BL13–BL28)

Organ transport points — treats every zang-fu organ directly

- BL13 — Lung
- BL14 — Pericardium
- BL15 — Heart
- BL18 — Liver
- BL19 — Gallbladder
- BL20 — Spleen
- BL21 — Stomach
- BL22 — San Jiao
- BL23 — Kidney
- BL25 — Large Intestine
- BL27 — Small Intestine
- BL28 — Bladder

FUNCTION LOGIC

- Running-course function: Two branches cross the head/brain -> headache. Two long parallel lines run the entire back -> low back pain, calf pain, stiff leg, sciatica-type pain along the pathway.
- Internal-organ function: Pertains to the Bladder -> urination disorders. Dr. Zhang notes acupuncture is particularly effective for urinary retention — cites a clinical case where a single point resolved the presentation.
- Back-Shu bridge function: BL13–BL28 are the Back-Shu (transport) points for all twelve zang-fu organs, so BL is also the channel you reach for to treat any other organ system via its associated Back-Shu point (e.g., BL13 Lung, BL15 Heart, BL18 Liver, BL20 Spleen, BL21 Stomach, BL23 Kidney, BL25 Large Intestine, BL27 Small Intestine, BL28 Bladder).

TRAP NOTES

! TRAP: BL does NOT connect to the Lung. Do not confuse with LU or the Metal-element pathway — BL's internal connection is Kidney only (confirmed midterm-era trap note).

! The two parallel lines on the back (1.5 cun and 3 cun lateral to the spine) run SIMULTANEOUSLY, not as a sequential loop. Dr. Zhang confirmed in Q&A: a student asked whether the back line travels down, back up, and down again, or runs both lines at the same time — answer: "at the same time." Do not draw it as one line doubling back.

! BL has 14 cross-points total, shared with two other channels: the Governor Vessel (GV) and the Gallbladder (GB) channel, concentrated around the head. You are not expected to know each of the 14 individually — only that BL shares crossing points with GV and GB.

! BL7 (Tongtian) is NOT the vertex-joining point — that is GV20 (Baihui), which BL merely joins at the vertex.

CLINICAL PEARLS

- BL40 (Weizhong): He-Sea, Command point for the back; clears summer-heat; low back pain.
- Back-Shu points (BL13–BL28): organ transport points — treat the corresponding zang-fu organ directly from the back.
- BL60 (Kunlun): called the "aspirin of acupuncture" — headache, pain anywhere along the pathway, difficult labor.
- BL67 (Zhiyin): corrects fetal malposition with moxibustion; used for labor induction.
- BL62 (Shenmai) and BL63 (Jinmen) sit close together on the lateral foot below the malleolus — BL62 is the Confluent point (opens Yang Qiao Mai); BL63 is the Xi-Cleft.

COMMONLY CONFUSED

- BL40 vs BL54 vs BL57: All are leg/thigh points on the same posterior line: BL40 Weizhong (popliteal crease, He-Sea/Command) -> BL54 Zhibian (upper thigh/sacrum) -> BL57 Chengshan (calf belly, 8 cun below BL40). Sequence matters for the running-course quiz format.

The Kidney Meridian of Foot-Shaoyin

Yin | Water | 5 PM – 7 PM | 27 pts

PATHWAY — 3 branches

1st: KI1 Yongquan · Last: KI27 Shufu

1. Small toe -> kidney -> bladder (main pathway)
2. kidney (re-emerging) -> root of the tongue
3. lung -> Pericardium Meridian

SPECIAL POINTS

- Jing-Well: KI1 Yongquan
- Ying-Spring: KI2 Rangu
- Shu-Stream: KI3 Taixi
- Jing-River: KI7 Fuli
- He-Sea: KI10 Yingu
- Yuan-Source: KI3 Taixi
- Luo-Connecting: KI4 Dazhong
- Xi-Cleft: KI5 Shuiquan
- Front-Mu (of Kidney): GB25 Jingmen
- Back-Shu (of Kidney): BL23 Shenshu
- Confluent (opens Yinqiao Mai): KI6 Zhaohai

FUNCTION LOGIC

- Running-course function: Pathway curves behind the medial malleolus/heel -> heel pain (Dr. Zhang's explicit clinical cue). Terminates at the tongue root -> dry mouth, sore throat, tongue-root diagnostic signs.
- Internal-organ function: Kidney stores Essence (Jing) and grasps Qi (governs respiration at its root) — treats asthma-type presentations because the channel connects internally with the Lung. Also governs water metabolism, bone, marrow, and hearing.

TRAP NOTES

! CLINICAL TEACHING POINT (Dr. Zhang, verbatim emphasis): heel pain — think Kidney first. The channel curves directly behind the medial malleolus and through the heel, and this is called out explicitly as a common clinical presentation.

! KI intersects the Spleen channel at SP6 (Sanyinjiao) on the medial leg — a shared crossing point, not a KI-numbered point.

! Do not confuse KI3 (Taixi, Yuan-source AND Shu-stream — a dual role) with KI7 (Fuli, Jing-river). Both sit near the medial malleolus/Achilles tendon: KI3 is in the depression between the malleolus tip and the Achilles tendon; KI7 is 2 cun above KI3, anterior to the Achilles tendon.

! KI6 (Zhaohai) is the Confluent point opening the Yinqiao Mai (Yin Heel Vessel) — do not mix up with KI7, which is a Jing-river (five-transport) point with a different clinical profile.

CLINICAL PEARLS

- KI1 (Yongquan): Jing-Well; resuscitation, calms the spirit; used in hypertension.
- KI3 (Taixi): Yuan-source; the key tonic point for Kidney Yin AND Yang.
- KI6 (Zhaohai): Confluent (Yinqiao Mai); insomnia, sore throat, irregular menstruation.
- KI7 (Fuli): tonifies Kidney Yang; edema; night sweats (often paired with HT6).
- KI27 (Shufu): final point of the channel, inferior border of the clavicle — links functionally into the chest before the Pericardium channel begins.

COMMONLY CONFUSED

- BL60 vs BL62/BL63: BL60 Kunlun (Jing-River, mid-Achilles) sits above BL62 Shenmai (Confluent, directly below malleolus) and BL63 Jinmen (Xi-Cleft, anterior-inferior to BL62). All three cluster around the lateral ankle — map them from the malleolus outward.
- KI3 vs KI7: KI3 Taixi = Shu-Stream + Yuan-Source, in the malleolus/Achilles depression. KI7 Fuli = Jing-River, 2 cun proximal to KI3, anterior to the Achilles tendon.
- KI6 vs KI7: KI6 Zhaohai (Confluent, Yinqiao Mai, below the malleolus) is functionally distinct from KI7 Fuli (Jing-River, tonifies Yang) despite being nearby.

Full Point Grid — Quick Scan

BL — all 67 points

BL1	Jingming	BL13	Feishu	BL25	Dachangshu	BL37	Yinmen	BL49	Yishe	BL61	Pucan
BL2	Zanzhu	BL14	Jueyinshu	BL26	Guanyuanshu	BL38	Fuxi	BL50	Weicang	BL62	Shenmai
BL3	Meichong	BL15	Xinshu	BL27	Xiaochangshu	BL39	Weiyang	BL51	Huangmen	BL63	Jinmen
BL4	Quchai	BL16	Dushu	BL28	Panguangshu	BL40	Weizhong	BL52	Zhishi	BL64	Jinggu
BL5	Wuchu	BL17	Geshu	BL29	Zhonglvshu	BL41	Fufen	BL53	Baohuang	BL65	Shugu
BL6	Chengguang	BL18	Ganshu	BL30	Baihuanshu	BL42	Pohu	BL54	Zhibian	BL66	Zutonggu
BL7	Tongtian	BL19	Danshu	BL31	Shangliao	BL43	Gaohuang	BL55	Heyang	BL67	Zhiyin
BL8	Luoque	BL20	Pishu	BL32	Ciliao	BL44	Shentang	BL56	Chengjin		
BL9	Yuzhen	BL21	Weishu	BL33	Zhongliao	BL45	Yixi	BL57	Chengshan		
BL10	Tianzhu	BL22	Sanjiaoshu	BL34	Xialiao	BL46	Geguan	BL58	Feiyang		
BL11	Dazhu	BL23	Shenshu	BL35	Huiyang	BL47	Hunmen	BL59	Fuyang		
BL12	Fengmen	BL24	Qihai	BL36	Chengfu	BL48	Yanggang	BL60	Kunlun		

KI — all 27 points

KI1	Yongquan	KI6	Zhaohai	KI11	Henggu	KI16	Huangshu	KI21	Youmen	KI26	Yuzhong
KI2	Rangu	KI7	Fuliu	KI12	Dahe	KI17	Shangqu	KI22	Bulang	KI27	Shufu
KI3	Taixi	KI8	Jiaoxin	KI13	Qixue	KI18	Shiguan	KI23	Shenfeng		
KI4	Dazhong	KI9	Zhubin	KI14	Siman	KI19	Yindu	KI24	Lingxu		
KI5	Shuiquan	KI10	Yingu	KI15	Zhongzhu	KI20	Futonggu	KI25	Shencang		

COURSE MILESTONE

Week 5 completes the Posterior Circuit (also called Inner Circuit on earlier slide versions): HT and SI (Week 4) plus BL and KI (this week) form the full four-channel posterior/inner circuit. Dr. Zhang's own framing at the end of Lecture 5: "until now, we have learned the posterior circuit, and four meridians consist of the posterior circuit."

5-TRANSPORT QUICK MAP

BL (Yang): Jing-Well=BL67(Metal) · Ying-Spring=BL66(Water) · Shu-Stream=BL65(Wood) · Jing-River=BL60(Fire) · He-Sea=BL40(Earth)
 KI (Yin): Jing-Well=KI1(Wood) · Ying-Spring=KI2(Fire) · Shu-Stream=KI3(Earth) · Jing-River=KI7(Metal) · He-Sea=KI10(Water)

BL vs KI — At a Glance

Circuit direction	Descends, head->foot	Ascends, foot->chest
Back-Shu	BL28 (of itself)	BL23
Front-Mu	CV3 Zhongji	GB25 Jingmen
Confluent	BL62 (Yang Qiao Mai)	KI6 (Yin Qiao Mai)
Command/unique	BL40 Command (back)	Only ch. to tongue root